Weekly Bulletin of IT News and Articles

(16 February 2026 – 23 February 2026)

Department of Strategy and Analysis
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CIS NEWS

1. Kazakhstan's first agro techno-park opens in Astana

(The Times of Central Asia)

Kazakhstan's first agro techno-park has begun operations in Astana, creating a new infrastructure platform for the development and implementation of high-tech solutions in the agro-industrial complex *(AIC)*. The project was launched at Saken Seifullin Kazakh Agrotechnical Research University and is aimed at supporting innovation in the Akmola region, one of the country's key grain-producing areas.

According to the Ministry of Agriculture, the agro techno-park will serve as a hub for business incubation, startup support, and the piloting of modern agricultural technologies, with their subsequent introduction into Kazakhstan's agribusiness sector.

The agro techno-park covers approximately 1,000 square meters. Its facilities include a production and engineering unit with a metalworking workshop for experimental and pilot projects, office space for resident companies, and a full-cycle laboratory complex. The site also houses the Kazakh-Australian Innovation Center for Molecular and Genetic Research on Agricultural Crops, as well as laboratories dedicated to agro-biotechnology and microbiology, physical and chemical analysis, and analytical research.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/kazakhstans-first-agro-techno-park-opens-in-astana/)

2. Kazakhstan launches high-resolution weather forecast powered by supercomputer

(The Times of Central Asia)

Kazakhstan has introduced a new high-resolution digital weather forecasting system powered by the country's most powerful supercomputer, marking a significant step toward strengthening national hydrometeorological security.

The National Hydrometeorological Service, Kazhydromet, has deployed the Weather Research and Forecasting *(WRF)* model across the entire territory of the country. The system provides forecasts with a spatial resolution of 2 kilometers, significantly enhancing the accuracy and detail of weather predictions.

All computations are carried out on Central Asia's most powerful supercomputer at the Farabi Supercomputer Center, located at Al-Farabi Kazakh National University in Almaty.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/kazakhstan-launches-high-resolution-weather-forecast-powered-by-supercomputer/)

3. Google Tax delivers over $ 275 million as Kazakhstan tightens digital oversight

(The Astana Times)

Since the introduction of the digital services tax, widely known as the Google Tax, Kazakhstan's budget has collected 136 billion tenge *($ 275.6 million)*, the State Revenue Committee of the Ministry of Finance reported on Feb. 19.

The Google tax was implemented in 2022. Since then, 120 foreign companies have registered to pay it, including 22 in 2025. Total revenues reached 136 billion tenge *($ 275.6 million)*, of which 57.6 billion tenge *($ 116.7 million)* was collected in 2025, and 8.7 billion tenge *($ 17.6 million)* in Jan. 2026.

Under the Tax Code of Kazakhstan, second-tier banks and payment organizations provide information to the State Revenue Committee on foreign companies that have completed conditional registration. These data are used to check whether foreign companies have fully and timely paid taxes when selling products online and providing digital services to individuals in the country.

Based on comparisons of information from second-tier banks, payment organizations, and data on VAT paid by foreign companies, the State Revenue Committee conducts a desk audit. If non-payment or underpayment is detected, the desk audit generates notifications of the discrepancies.

"According to **Article 89 of the Tax Code of Kazakhstan**, from Jan. 1, 2026, provisions allow the State Revenue Committee to block the websites of foreign marketplaces if they fail to comply with desk audit notifications or with requirements to register as VAT payers," the Committee noted.

(Read full article at https://astanatimes.com/2026/02/google-tax-delivers-over-275-million-as-kazakhstan-tightens-digital-oversight/)

4. Kazakhstan expands digital tenge use across key economic sectors

(The Astana Times)

The National Payment Corporation of Kazakhstan has outlined ongoing projects to integrate the digital tenge into multiple sectors of the economy. The digital tenge is a third form of the national currency, alongside cash and bank deposits. Issued by the National Bank of Kazakhstan, it combines the advantages of both cash and non-cash payments.

Beginning in 2024, the digital tenge has been applied in eight pilot scenarios. Total issuance under these projects reached 336.6 billion digital tenge *($ 685.9 million)*, with more than 1,000 transactions conducted.

One of the primary applications has been monitoring how the National Fund's allocations are spent. Major infrastructure projects, including the Dostyk-Moiynty railway and the Taldykorgan-Usharal gas pipeline, were financed using a digital currency marking mechanism, enabling authorities to track expenditures.

In 2024-2025, the instrument was also used to subsidize leasing for agricultural machinery and equipment, as well as to finance livestock purchases under the state's Auyl-Amanaty rural development program.

Additionally, pilot projects were launched during 2024-2025 to finance two medium-term road repair initiatives in the Atyrau and Pavlodar Regions.

Another initiative is the Digital VAT mechanism, which reduces VAT refund times for exporters from 90 days to five business days.

The currency is also being tested in market applications. A pilot project, for example, monitored the targeted use of funds by the Kazakhstan Football Federation.

(Read full article at https://astanatimes.com/2026/02/kazakhstan-expands-digital-tenge-use-across-key-economic-sectors/)

5. AI for inclusive growth: new frontier in India–Kazakhstan cooperation

(The Astana Times)

India's hosting of the Artificial Intelligence Summit in New Delhi on Feb. 19-20, 2026, under the theme "Sarvajan Hitaya, Sarvajan Sukhaya – Welfare for All, Happiness for All," marks an important milestone in advancing a shared global vision for technology that is ethical, inclusive, and firmly centered on human well-being. The participation of heads of state and government, alongside leading voices from the global AI technology ecosystem, reflects a growing consensus that AI is emerging as one of the defining forces of our era. When guided responsibly, AI has the power to transform economies, strengthen governance, and address complex developmental challenges.

AI is not an end in itself but a powerful instrument that must be harnessed to augment human capability in various fields. In healthcare, it can broaden access to high-quality diagnostics and accurate treatment. In education, AI can democratize learning and expand opportunities for skill development. In governance, it offers pathways for greater transparency, efficient delivery, and improved decision-making. AI-driven innovation holds immense promise in climate mitigation, energy optimization, modern agriculture, smarter development and in planning sustainable cities.

Within this evolving global landscape, India and Kazakhstan, longstanding strategic partners bound by mutual respect and shared aspirations, are uniquely positioned to deepen cooperation in AI as a cornerstone in their bilateral engagements. Kazakhstan has taken a significant step toward preparing its next generation for its digital future by introducing AI into the higher education curriculum. This forward-looking initiative reflects a national commitment to cultivate advanced digital skills, fostering innovation by embedding AI literacy in academic institutions. Complementing this effort is Kazakhstan's innovation ecosystem, including initiatives such as the Alem AI platform, which aim to accelerate technological progress and regional leadership.

(Read full article at https://astanatimes.com/2026/02/ai-for-inclusive-growth-new-frontier-in-india-kazakhstan-cooperation/)

6. New VAT proposal signals Russia's tightening regulation of cross-border digital marketplaces

(Habr)

The Russian State Duma Committee on Industry and Trade has supported a proposal to introduce a Value Added Tax *(VAT)* on imported goods sold through digital marketplaces, regardless of the current duty-free threshold *(which presently exempts personal parcels under 200 euros and 31 kg).* This initiative aims to level the playing field between domestic and foreign sellers by closing existing regulatory loopholes in cross-border direct shipments. Two competing implementation plans are currently under consideration: the Ministry of Industry and Trade advocates for an immediate full VAT of 22% starting January 1, 2027, while the Ministry of Finance suggests a phased increase from 5% in 2027 to 20% by 2030.

Additionally, the committee recommended several measures to protect domestic industries, including establishing preferential marketplace commission rates for Russian suppliers, integrating platforms with Rospatent for intellectual property control, and revoking conformity certificates from non-compliant EAEU regulatory bodies. Broader domestic support initiatives include expanding the "Chestny ZNAK" mandatory labeling system to luggage and leather goods, increasing annual equipment leasing subsidies to 1.5 billion rubles, and developing exchange trading for wool.

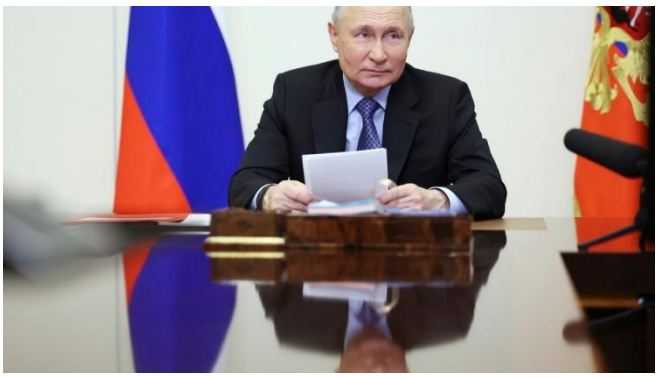
This legislative push represents a definitive shift toward protectionism in Russia's e-commerce and light industry sectors. By aggressively closing the long-standing cross-border tax loophole that favored cheap foreign direct-to-consumer imports, and simultaneously combining it with preferential treatment and increased subsidies for local manufacturers, the government is actively engineering a market environment designed to artificially boost the competitiveness and profitability of domestic producers.

(Read full article at https://habr.com/ru/news/1000162/)

7. Crackdown on crypto: Russian President signs law permitting seizure of digital assets

(Habr)

Russian President Vladimir Putin has signed Federal Law No. 38-FZ *(dated February 20, 2026)*, officially permitting the arrest and seizure of digital currency during criminal proceedings. The legislation formally recognizes cryptocurrency as "property" under the Russian Criminal and Criminal Procedure Codes, aiming to mitigate risks associated with its illicit use. Under the new regulations, investigators, assisted by technical specialists, are authorized to either seize physical hardware *(such as computers, servers, or cold wallets)* containing crypto access codes, or directly transfer the digital assets to a secure, state-



controlled identifier address. The court retains the authority to mandate the formal arrest of these assets for potential confiscation or to secure civil claims, while the Russian government is tasked with establishing the exact procedures for their storage and transfer. The law, which solidifies existing investigative practices, takes effect 10 days after its official publication.

This legislation represents a critical formalization of digital asset regulation within the Russian legal framework. By legally defining cryptocurrency as seizable property and establishing clear technical and procedural protocols for its physical and digital confiscation, the state is equipping its law enforcement agencies with the necessary legal tools to systematically trace, seize, and control decentralized financial assets linked to criminal activities or the shadow economy.

(Read full article at https://habr.com/ru/news/1002168/)

8. AnBonus Launches First AI-Driven Social Commerce Pilot in Russia

(Openpr.com)

On February 17, 2026, AnBonus *(ООО "ABOUNY")* launched its inaugural AI-powered social commerce pilot in Moscow, Russia. The platform is specifically tailored to align with local cultural and consumer patterns, marking the company's focus on localized digital engagement. To ensure operational stability, the initiative includes comprehensive training and resource support for local teams, serving as a strategic testbed to gather insights for potential broader market expansion.

This pilot represents AnBonus's calculated entry into the Russian digital market, leveraging a "glocalized" strategy that adapts global AI trends to specific regional behaviors. It indicates that the company is using Moscow as a controlled environment to validate its operational model and technology before committing to wider scale-up efforts.

(Read full article at https://www.openpr.com/news/4394173/anbonus-launches-first-ai-driven-social-commerce-pilot)

9. The future of money in Russia: digital ruble arrives in September 2026

(Habr)

According to the head of the Central Bank of Russia, Elvira Nabiullina, Russian citizens will officially gain access to the digital ruble starting September 1, 2026. This launch marks the introduction of the third form of the national currency *(alongside cash and non-cash)*. From this date, citizens will be able to receive their salaries in digital rubles, and 12 major Russian banks, handling 80% of the country's money turnover, will be required to process

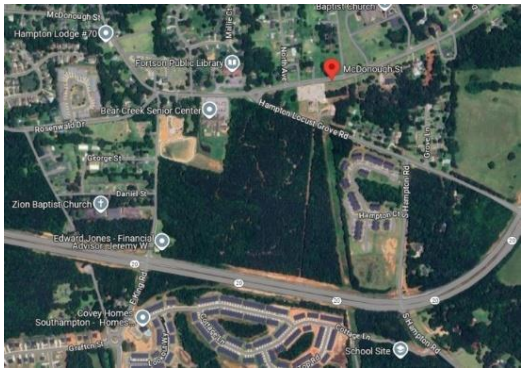
digital ruble transactions. Additionally, companies with an annual revenue exceeding 120 million rubles will be mandated to accept the new currency by September. This phased rollout will expand in autumn 2027 to include companies with a turnover over 30 million rubles, and by 2028 to all banks and trading companies exceeding 5 million rubles. Recently, the first successful state contract settlement using the digital ruble was completed instantly among four contractors via the VTB Bank and "Mosinzhproekt."

The mandatory integration of the digital ruble starting in September 2026 signifies a major structural shift in Russia's financial ecosystem. By forcing the country's largest banks and high-revenue businesses to adopt the Central Bank Digital Currency *(CBDC)* early on, the Russian government is establishing a highly centralized, transparent, and instantly traceable payment infrastructure. This move not only modernizes state and commercial settlements but significantly tightens the Central Bank's direct oversight of domestic financial flows.

(Read full article at https://habr.com/ru/news/996374/)

GLOBAL NEWS

10. 4 million sq. ft. Hampton technology park data center campus proposed Outside Atlanta, Georgia



A new 4 million square foot data center campus, dubbed Hampton Technology Park, has been proposed for the city of Hampton in Henry County, Georgia, approximately 35 miles south of Atlanta. The developer, operating under the alias "Client Company, LLC," has filed a Development of Regional Impact *(DRI)* application for a 603-acre site along Lower Woolsey Road. The project envisions five buildings with a build-out timeline extending to 2033. However, the proposal faces potential delays as the city of Hampton is currently considering a 120-day moratorium on data center developments to assess their local impact.

This proposal highlights the rapid expansion of Atlanta from a Tier 2 market into a major hyperscale data center hub, extending development beyond the traditional Fulton County cluster into surrounding areas like Henry County. The simultaneous push for a development moratorium indicates growing friction between municipal authorities and developers, as local governments seek to better understand the long-term infrastructure and environmental implications of such massive projects before granting approval.

(Read full article at https://constructionreviewonline.com/4-million-sq-ft-hampton-technology-park-data-center-campus-proposed-outside-atlanta-georgia/)

11. AI-led disruption is real: what it means for the economy, stock market investors

(Mint)

As artificial intelligence rapidly transitions from a fringe technology to a mainstream business driver, global markets are experiencing sell-offs fueled by fears of AI-induced job losses and economic upheaval. The Indian IT sector, which contributes 7–7.5% of India's GDP and is a major source of exports and employment, is facing significant pressure, with major stocks like TCS, Infosys, and Wipro hitting 52-week lows. Investors are anxious that AI advancements could erode pricing power, deal wins, and long-term earnings for traditional software services. Economists warn that a sustained AI-driven downturn in the IT sector could trigger severe macroeconomic consequences, including reduced urban disposable income, a slump in real estate markets in hubs like Bengaluru and Pune, widened current account deficits, and decreased corporate tax revenues.

The rapid advancement of AI poses a critical structural threat to India's traditional IT-dependent economic model. While the market may currently be overestimating the immediate collapse of the sector, the potential "ripple effect" of mass IT job losses, spanning real estate, banking, and consumer goods, highlights the urgent need for Indian IT companies to aggressively pivot and adapt AI to enhance productivity, rather than viewing it solely as a disruptive force, to avert broader macroeconomic instability.

(Read full article at https://www.livemint.com/market/stock-market-news/ai-disruption-indian-it-stocks-economy-stock-market-investors-11771144542371.html)

12. U.K. introduces VCT rule changes in April

(Saffery)

From 6 April 2026, an investor can obtain income tax relief for investments in the fund at 20% on up to £ 200,000 investment a year *(30% before 6 April 2026)*. This relief is withdrawn where the investor doesn't hold the VCT shares for at least five years. Dividends paid out by the VCT on investments within the £ 200,000 annual limit are received free of income tax, and the subsequent sale of VCT shares is free of CGT.

This applies only to investments in newly issued shares. If the investor buys pre-existing shares in the VCT on the market, these reliefs will not apply.

What types of companies do VCTs invest in?

Conditions for the relief to apply include:

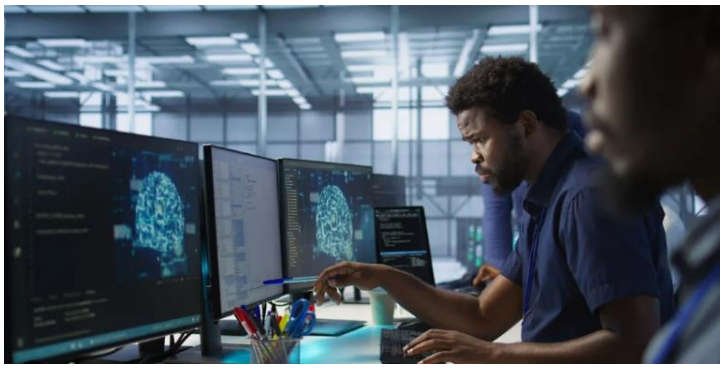
1. The VCT must be listed on an EU regulated market;

2. The VCT's investments must be diversified with no more than 15% of its investments in a single company;
3. At least 80% of its investments must be in 'qualifying holdings', broadly in UK-resident companies *(or companies with a UK permanent establishment)* carrying on a qualifying trade;
4. The same expanded company limits that apply for EIS also apply for VCT investments from 6 April 2026, including the higher £ 30 million/£ 35 million gross assets thresholds and the increased annual and lifetime company investment limits *(£ 10 million/£ 24 million, or £ 20 million/£ 40 million for knowledge-intensive companies),* and
5. As with EIS and SEIS, certain trades are excluded.

(Read full article at https://www.saffery.com/insights/articles/eis-seis-vct-and-uk-investment-tax-reliefs-explained/#:~:text=raise%20under%20EIS%3F-,For%20shares%20issued%20on%20or%20after%206%20April%202026%2C%20the,million%20before%206%20April%202026)

13. African Union Commission and Google sign landmark partnership to advance Africa's sovereign AI and digital capacity

(Africa Union)



On February 17, 2026, the African Union Commission *(AUC)* and Google signed a landmark Memorandum of Understanding *(MoU)* in Addis Ababa to advance Africa's sovereign artificial intelligence and digital capacity. Guided by the AU's Continental AI Strategy and the Digital Transformation Strategy for Africa *(2020–2030)*, the partnership prioritizes AI and cloud infrastructure, talent development, research, startup ecosystem growth, and responsible AI governance. Google's Regional Director for Sub-Saharan Africa, Charles Njenga Murito, announced new initiatives, including an AI readiness training program for public officials, a goal to train 3 million students and teachers by 2030, and free access to Gemini Pro and NotebookLM with support for local languages like Amharic. The collaboration aims to move the continent "from digital access to digital agency."

This partnership represents a strategic move to build Africa's indigenous digital resilience and sovereign technological capabilities rather than relying solely on foreign technology adoption. By combining Google's massive training commitments and localized AI tools with the African Union's development frameworks, the initiative aims to empower a new generation of African innovators and policymakers, ensuring the continent participates globally in the AI revolution on its own terms.

(Read full article at https://au.int/sw/node/46035)

14. Vietnam to gain access to critical US technologies after agreements with Trump

(UNN)

Following a meeting between U.S. President Donald Trump and Vietnamese leader To Lam, Vietnam has reached an agreement with the U.S. administration **to gain access to previously restricted American technologies in artificial intelligence *(AI)* and semiconductors.** To facilitate this shift and position Hanoi as a key U.S. manufacturing hub in Asia replacing China, Vietnam is preparing a new legislative framework to protect American intellectual property. Additionally, the agreement mandates strict monitoring to prevent these advanced technologies from being transferred to countries under U.S. sanctions. This strategic decision by the White House is expected to drive a massive influx of investments into Vietnam's high-tech sector, potentially doubling it by the end of 2026 and creating thousands of jobs.

This agreement marks a major geopolitical and economic realignment by Washington aimed at reshaping the technological supply chain in Asia. By easing export restrictions and integrating Vietnam into its advanced tech ecosystem, the U.S. is actively accelerating its manufacturing decoupling from China while empowering a new, reliable regional partner equipped with stringent intellectual property and security safeguards.

(Read full article at https://unn.ua/en/amp/vietnam-to-gain-access-to-critical-us-technologies-after-agreements-with-trump)

15. IIT Madras Global to establish its first applied AI Innovation Centre at Dubai CommerCity

(iitm.ac.in)

The IIT Madras Global Research Foundation signed a Memorandum of Understanding *(MoU)* on the sidelines of WORLDEF Dubai 2026 to establish its first Applied Artificial Intelligence Innovation Centre at Dubai CommerCity. Facilitated by strategic partner MCA Gulf, the center aims to accelerate AI innovation, commercialize deep-tech solutions, and support technology-led economic growth across the Middle East, Africa, and South Asia *(MEASA)* region. In its initial phase, the facility will host six applied AI startups with a combined valuation of approximately $ 118 million and projected five-year revenues of $ 281 million. The initiative aligns with the India-UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement *(CEPA)* and the Dubai Economic Agenda D33, focusing on local

intellectual property creation, high-skill job generation, and advancing sectors like smart cities, energy, and logistics.

This establishment represents a major milestone in the global expansion of India's premier academic institutions, translating IIT Madras's research capabilities into scalable, market-ready commercial applications on an international stage. By strategically anchoring its first global AI hub in Dubai's digital commerce free zone, IIT Madras is proactively solidifying the India-UAE technology corridor and positioning itself as a direct catalyst for deep-tech commercialization and economic diversification in the broader GCC region.

(Read full article at https://www.iitm.ac.in/happenings/press-releases-and-coverages/iit-madras-global-establish-its-first-applied-ai-innovation)

16. Trump unveils 'Tech Corps' to promote American AI abroad

(CNBC)

As competition with China intensifies, Washington is turning to a cornerstone of American soft power and diplomacy to expand its global influence in artificial intelligence: the Peace Corps. The White House announced the "Tech Corps" initiative within the Peace Corps aimed at promoting American AI abroad and helping partner nations adopt cutting-edge systems.

The Peace Corps is an independent U.S. government agency that sends American volunteers abroad to support local development projects, including in education, health, agriculture and economic growth.

The new Tech Corps will be structured similarly but will recruit, train, and deploy volunteers with tech skills, including engineers and graduates in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics to provide "last-mile" support for the implementation of American AI solutions abroad, particularly at the application layer.

A website for the Tech Corps has launched and is accepting applications, which it says will be accepted on a rolling basis.

In an announcement, the Peace Corps said that the AI solutions the new group implements would be put towards "real-world grassroots problems" in key sectors, including agriculture, education, health, and economic development.

Volunteers would be sent to countries participating in the American AI Exports Program, announced in July under a Trump administration executive order aimed at maintaining U.S. dominance in advanced technologies globally.

(Read full article at https://www.cnbc.com/2026/02/23/us-launch-peace-corps-tech-corps-india-export-ai-stack-sovereignty-counter-china.html)

17. How the global effort to keep AI safe went off the rails

(Politico)

Those gathered in New Delhi are no longer obsessing about how to control AI risks but figuring out who can benefit.

It started as an elite political conversation in an English country house to rein in this generation's most powerful technology. Now it's a business dealmaking free-for-all in an Indian megacity.

The annual global artificial intelligence summit, which takes place in New Delhi this week, has grown from 150 to 35,000 delegates in less than three years. In the process, the original motivation for the summit – as a global conversation to agree on safeguards to keep AI technology in check – has been relegated to quiet corners of the gathering.

On the surface, the Indian organizers of this year's event have some aspects of AI safety in mind, at least according to the lofty slogans on street billboards dotted throughout the city.

Yet the final summit declaration set to be agreed later this week will fail to include the word "safety," according to a draft text reported exclusively by POLITICO. After the first two summits addressed catastrophic risks to humanity and threats like job losses and environmental damage, India has instead switched the focus to practical applications and dealmaking.

(Read full article at https://www.politico.eu/article/how-the-global-effort-to-keep-ai-safe-went-off-the-rails/)

ANALYSIS

18. How Central Asia accelerates AI adoption in finance

(The Astana Times)

Financial institutions across Central Asia are accelerating the adoption of artificial intelligence, with 36% already using AI technologies and 56% planning implementation within a year, according to a report released Feb. 13 by the National Bank of Kazakhstan.

Based on a survey of 232 financial organizations in Kazakhstan, the Kyrgyz Republic, and Tajikistan, the study offers the region's first comprehensive assessment of AI integration in financial markets.

Despite strong interest, implementation remains at an early stage: 38% of respondents are conducting research, 28% are running pilot or partial projects, and only 2% have reached full-scale deployment.

"In 2026, the National Bank will focus on transitioning to the practical implementation of a digital asset market and integrating it into Kazakhstan's existing financial system. Plans also include the development of a unified AI ecosystem, the creation of a platform of specialized AI agents within the Bank, and regional collaboration in AI to develop practically applicable AI solutions," said National Bank Governor Timur Suleimenov in the paper's foreword.

According to him, this approach ensures risk manageability, institutional readiness and compliance with regulatory requirements as AI agents, autonomous systems capable of performing tasks with limited human oversight, become more complex.

The digital asset initiative is part of a broader transition toward AI-supported supervision and agent-based systems that automate analytical and monitoring functions in the financial sector.

The report shows that AI adoption in Central Asia is gradually moving beyond basic process automation toward predictive analytics and risk-focused applications. Early use centered on improving operational efficiency. Financial institutions are now increasingly applying AI to fraud detection, credit assessment and customer data analysis to support decision-making.

In Kazakhstan, 75% of banks use AI, and 88% intend to expand their application. However, deployment remains concentrated in transactional and customer-facing areas, particularly credit scoring and anti-fraud systems. Use in strategic planning, compliance oversight and comprehensive risk management remains limited and largely at an initial stage of implementation.

The report also highlights the growing importance of generative AI, systems capable of producing text, images, or other content, and AI agents that can perform semi-autonomous tasks.

Globally, agent-based AI systems are projected to grow at an average annual rate of 45% over the next five years. The U.S.-based research firm Gartner forecasts that by 2027, AI agents could participate in or support 50% of business decisions. McKinsey data cited in the report suggest that restructuring workflows around AI agents can reduce task execution time by 60% to 90%, depending on the application.

The study places Central Asia within a rapidly expanding global AI landscape. Corporate investment in AI reached $ 252.3 billion in 2024, up 26% from 2023. Over the past decade, investment volumes have grown nearly thirteenfold.

(Read full article at https://astanatimes.com/2026/02/how-central-asia-accelerates-ai-adoption-in-finance/)

19. How AI, cost pressures and reskilling are transforming talent strategies

(AON)

AI acceleration, rising healthcare costs and changes to workforce skills are transforming organizations. Our analysis of financial services, life sciences and technology companies provides insights on how to redesign roles, reskill at scale and reimagine talent strategies to stay competitive.

The labor market is in flux. Employee turnover and hiring are trending lower, artificial intelligence *(AI)* is reshaping workforce

skills and total rewards budgets are being squeezed by rising healthcare costs. People leaders know these pressures, but the changes are far from uniform; each industry is moving through its own version of disruption. That is why it's vital to have timely, sector-specific data and insights that address different scenarios.

Aon's talent and analytics teams analyzed internal and external data, including the Radford McLagan Compensation Database, covering more than 4,200 technology, life sciences and financial services companies across the globe. In each sector, several significant workforce shifts are afoot, and understanding their various impacts is crucial.

Organizations across financial services, technology and life sciences are experiencing fast-moving shifts driven by AI, cost pressures and evolving workforce needs. Although each sector is responding differently, three priority areas are emerging for leaders preparing for what's next. We explain how these major forces are impacting each sector and what talent and HR leaders can do to respond.

Priority #1: Optimize the workforce for the AI era

As AI adoption accelerates across all three sectors, organizations are rethinking how work is structured and where it's done. The end goal is to align job roles, spans (the number of employees reporting to a manger), layers (the number of management tiers) and location footprint with business priorities to be most efficient and effective.

Priority #2: Identify critical skills and focus on reskilling and upskilling

As digital and AI skills evolve faster than most organizations' ability to adapt, building future-ready capabilities is essential. This means accelerating reskilling and upskilling plans, creating clearer career pathways and making smart "build versus buy versus bot" decisions. This allows talent to move easily to where it's needed most.

Priority #3: Attract and retain critical talent with a compelling EVP

Even as turnover declines across sectors, other factors such as cost-of-living pressures, wellbeing and evolving expectations around flexibility and career development continue to influence engagement and retention. Strengthening the employee value proposition *(EVP)* is essential for holding onto scarce specialist talent.

(Read full article at https://www.aon.com/en/insights/articles/how-ai-cost-pressures-and-reskilling-are-transforming-talent-strategies#:~:text=The%20technology%20sector%20remains%20the,the%20need%20for%20sustained%20reskilling)

Events calendar for IT PARK UZBEKISTAN, RESIDENTS OF IT PARK UZBEKISTAN and MINISTRY OF DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES – *(February 2026)*

IT PARK UZBEKISTAN					
Date	**Event name**	**Description**	**Location**	**Event holder**	**Official Website**
Feb 23	AI & Design: A New Era in Design	A specialized webinar hosted by Astana Hub focusing on integrating Generative AI into UI/UX workflows. Excellent for IT Park design studios.	Online	Astana Hub *(Qostanai Hub)*	astanahub.com
Feb 24-25	betterCode() Kotlin	A virtual technical conference for software engineers focusing on Kotlin best practices, backend development, and mobile apps.	Online / Russia	IT Community	https://www.bettercode.eu/
Feb 24	GT&BSC Event: A full and frank conversation about AI	A strategic UK webinar on buyer sentiment toward AI in global outsourcing. Crucial for IT Park and its residents targeting British clients.	Online	GSA UK	https://www.google.com/search?q=gsa-uk.com
Feb 26	Cursor Meetup Dushanbe	The first official meetup in Tajikistan for developers using the AI-assisted "Cursor" IDE. A great virtual networking opportunity for Uzbek coders to collaborate regionally.	Online / Dushanbe	Luma / Cursor Community	luma.com/cursorcommunity
Feb 26	Sourcing Social: Service as Software	An online session exploring how to package BPO services as SaaS products, shifting away from standard hourly billing models.	Online	GSA UK	https://www.google.com/search?q=gsa-uk.com
Feb 26	PT NGFW: Technical and Business Review	A specialized webinar on Next-Generation Firewalls by Positive Technologies. Mandatory knowledge for	Online	Positive Technologies	ict2go.ru

		IT Park cybersecurity teams.			
Feb 26-27	AI Coding Summit	A virtual summit focusing on AI-assisted programming tools, developer productivity enhancements, and autonomous agents.	Online / Russia	IT Community	https://aicodingsummit.com/
Feb 27	Int'l Conf on Small Business Growth and Sustainability	Strategic insights into designing support programs, incentives, and accelerators for early-stage resident startups.	Moscow, Russia *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 27	Int'l Conf on Corporate Governance, Compliance & Regulatory Frameworks	Best practices for regulatory frameworks, aiding IT Park in maintaining international standards for foreign investors.	Astana, Kazakhstan *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 27	Int'l Conf on Global Trends in Educational Innovation (ICGTEI)	Vital for IT Park's "IT Education" programs and scaling initiatives to build the country's talent pool.	Astana, Kazakhstan *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 27	Int'l Conf on Real Estate Law Innovations and Policy Reform	Important for adapting the Special Economic Zone *(SEZ)* legal frameworks to attract more IT infrastructure investments.	Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	conferencealerts.co.in
Feb 28	ICDSAITY 2026: Data Science, AI, and IT	Technical conference highlighting the intersection of AI algorithms and enterprise IT architectures.	Abu Dhabi, UAE *(Offline)*	Conference Alerts	conferencealerts.co.in
RESIDENTS OF IT PARK UZBEKISTAN					
Date	**Event name**	**Description**	**Location**	**Event holder**	**Official Website**
Feb 23	Solana SuperTeam Meetup: Web3 Careers	Focuses on Web3 grants, education, and blockchain development opportunities. Highly beneficial for Uzbek blockchain developers looking for funding.	Online / Kokshetau	Aqmola Hub	astanahub.com

Feb 23	ICBDCSI 2026: Big Data Computer Science	An academic and technical conference on Big Data infrastructure. Useful for resident startups building scalable architectures for the EU market.	Brussels, Belgium *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	allconferencealert.com
Feb 23-27	Power BI Summit	An online summit exploring data analytics, data visualization techniques, and enterprise business intelligence deployment.	Online / Russia	IT Community	https://globalpowerbisummit.com/
Feb 24	GT&BSC Event: A full and frank conversation about AI	A strategic UK webinar on buyer sentiment toward AI in global outsourcing. Crucial for IT Park and its residents targeting British clients.	Online	GSA UK	https://www.google.com/search?q=gsa-uk.com
Feb 25	ICCAIS 2026: Cryptography in AI Systems	A deep-dive technical event combining cybersecurity and Artificial Intelligence. Crucial for residents exporting software to high-security sectors.	Moscow, Russia *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 25	Int'l Conf on Optimization and Control in Applied Science	Technical event for software engineers working on complex algorithmic control systems and automation.	Moscow, Russia *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 25	Int'l Conf on Consumer Trust in E-Commerce Platforms	Crucial for e-commerce developers to understand security and UX patterns that drive user conversion and trust.	Moscow, Russia *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 26	Cursor Meetup Dushanbe	The first official meetup in Tajikistan for developers using the AI-assisted "Cursor" IDE. A great virtual networking opportunity for Uzbek	Online / Dushanbe	Luma / Cursor Community	luma.com/cursorcommunity

		coders to collaborate regionally.			
Feb 26	Open Source Forum	An online conference covering open-source software security, licensing, enterprise adoption, and community collaboration.	Online / Russia	IT Community	https://dev.events/EU/RU/Moscow/oss
Feb 26	Almaty Java Community Meetup	A high-level software engineering meetup tackling memory leaks in production Java apps. Great upskilling for senior backend developers.	Almaty, KZ / Online	SmArt.Point	astanahub.com
Feb 27	ICBDAMLTT 2026	Int'l Conf on Big Data Analytics and Machine Learning Tools for IT. A must-attend for local AI startups modeling big data.	Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 27	ICCISC 2026: Computational Intelligence	Focuses on soft computing methodologies and algorithmic trading. Beneficial for Uzbek fintech startups looking to expand into Kazakhstan.	Astana, Kazakhstan *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	conferencealerts.co.in
Feb 27 (Fri)	ICHCIIS 2026: Human-Computer Interaction	A European conference covering UI/UX and information science methodologies, key for teams building accessible e-government platforms.	Brussels, Belgium *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.net
Feb 28	Int'l Conf on Innovation and Technology in Sports *(ICITS)*	A niche opportunity for SportsTech developers to discover new software applications and IoT integrations.	Almaty, Kazakhstan *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.com
Feb 28	Int'l Conf on Computing E-learning and IT *(ICCEIT)*	Ideal for EdTech startups looking to integrate new computing methodologies and AI into their e-learning platforms.	Almaty, Kazakhstan *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	allconferencealert.com

Feb 28	UXUI Conf'26 Moscow	The premier professional UX/UI conference in Russia for product designers, offering insights into interface trends and design management.	Moscow, Russia *(Hybrid)*	Radisson Blu / Stachka	uxuiconf.ru
Feb 28	Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals *(AZ-900)*	Virtual certification prep for Azure cloud basics. Excellent for BPO residents proving cloud competencies and compliance to Western enterprise clients.	Online	Eventbrite	eventbrite.co.uk
Feb 28	ICCSBDA 2026: Cloud Security and Big Data	A critical European event on data protection and cloud compliance *(GDPR alignment)*, a must for BPO residents serving EU clients.	Brussels, Belgium *(Hybrid)*	Local Conference Center	conferencealerts.co.in
MINISTRY OF DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES					
Date	**Event name**	**Description**	**Location**	**Event holder**	**Official Website**
Feb 23-25	Security Engineering on AWS	Online training teaching cloud security best practices. Crucial for residents and Ministry security teams ensuring robust data protection for export clients.	Online	Fast Lane UK / AWS	flane.co.uk
Feb 24	Future-Proofing Supply Chains in 2026	A webinar examining how procurement teams navigate digitalization and geopolitical uncertainty, strategic for the Ministry's efforts in digitalizing logistics.	Online *(UK)*	Procurement Pro	procurementpro.com
Feb 24	OWASP 25th Anniversary Virtual Conference	A major online cybersecurity event focusing on web application security guidelines. Vital for	Online	OWASP	https://owasp.org/events/

		securing export-grade software.			
Feb 24-26	Crash Course: Deep Dive into LLM APIs	An intensive online masterclass for developers integrating Large Language Models into enterprise applications.	Online	IT Community	https://fwdays.com/en/event/llm-api-course
Feb 25	Get Ready for the 2026 Digital States Survey!	A benchmarking session for digital governance. Helps the Ministry understand global e-government ranking KPIs.	Online	Center for Digital Gov	webinars.govtech.com
Feb 25	techUK Geospatial LGR Working Group	An industry briefing on local government geospatial data. Beneficial for the Ministry's e-government teams rolling out Smart City and land registry systems.	Online	techUK	techuk.org
Feb 25	Digital Platforms Summit 2026	A strategic EU summit discussing the regulatory frameworks for digital platforms. Highly beneficial for the Ministry to benchmark local tech laws against EU standards.	Online / Brussels	Digital Platforms Summit	eurobrussels.com
Feb 25	Making Sense of AI in 2026: Social Impacts	A global webinar exploring the social risks and governance of AI deployment. Highly relevant for the Ministry drafting the National AI Strategy 2030 regulations.	Online (USA/Global)	BSR	bsr.org
Feb 25	Cybersecurity: Shield Your Business	An online workshop covering core cyber risks impacting small businesses. Mandatory knowledge for IT Park startups handling client data.	Online	Eventbrite	eventbrite.com
Feb 25	Mapping the Buyer Path From Need to Approval	A B2G *(Business-to-Government)* sales lab. Useful for Uzbek tech firms	Online	GovTech	events.govtech.com

		wanting to understand how to sell IT solutions to Western governments.			
Feb 25	Disaster Recovery Isn't Enough: Cyber Recovery Plan	Focuses on continuity during cyber incidents. Relevant for the Ministry's critical infrastructure protection protocols.	Online	GovTech	webinars.govtech.com
Feb 26-27	AI Coding Summit	A virtual summit dedicated to AI-assisted programming tools and autonomous agents to drastically boost developer productivity.	Online	IT Community	https://aicodingsummit.com/?utm_source
Feb 26	Sourcing Social: Service as Software	An online session exploring how to package BPO services as SaaS products, shifting away from standard hourly billing models.	Online	GSA UK	https://www.google.com/search?q=gsa-uk.com